

PERSONAL HISTORY STATEMENT

Aniket Ghosh

aniket.ghosh@gmail.com

I have spent my childhood traveling with my father, who was an SAP consultant for IBM. He used to work in different cities from Chicago to Bonn to Zurich and from there onward, I began seeing worlds where education, healthcare, and infrastructure seemed unbounded. During the same period, I also started working with my hometown's marginalized groups, where children were short on resources and opportunities in their lives. These were some stark contrasts that struck me deeply and planted a lifelong commitment to leveraging resources for systemic change where opportunity lags. That juxtaposition of stark contrasts planted a seed in my head, fostering a desire to bridge those gaps of opportunity. I knew even as a very young man that these disparities could, indeed, be rectified, fueling the lifelong commitment to work toward equality and opportunity for all.

I vividly remember building my very first computer, which I did at the age of 12. Saving months for motherboards, graphics cards, and other gadgets from local markets coupled with hundreds of hours in troubleshooting one hardware issue after another is a memory that I will never forget. But when it finally went through to an actual booting, the sense of satisfaction was huge, but much more profound was the realization that technology has this amazing ability to conjure out something where nothing exists. It is like a great leveler—it doesn't make differences and segregate but allows equal access and opportunity to everyone who goes through it. This experience taught me that nothing is unsolvable, provided one has enough patience and resourcefulness. That lesson has since burrowed into everything that came after—from coding competitions to real-world projects—driven by a faith that technology can bring equitable solutions and opportunities to all.

As my fascination for technology grew in me, so did my interest in the financial markets. Then, I started realizing that money is powerful, too, in bringing change beyond personal benefit. Finance, to me, amplifies the power behind ideas. My journey into investing was first about learning how companies operate and, on a macro scale, how whole industries work. This was an eye-opener into how financial resources, steered for a purpose, could fuel innovation, support causes, and create sustainable change. My investment journey was never about a return on investment, for one thing; it was first about understanding businesses and industries, and it later evolved into focusing on how investing can be understood as the ability to drive financial decision-making toward solving some of the world's biggest challenges—that is, for me, in education and healthcare.

Learning from people like Bill Gates, I've come to appreciate how financial acumen, when guided by empathy and integrity, can transform industries and improve lives. Initiatives like [AI-enabled ultrasounds](#) exemplify how technology and compassion together shape a brighter future. Inspired by this vision, I'm committed to carrying this approach forward in my own work, striving to make a lasting, positive difference.

For me, finance and technology are complementary tools for change. They can be abstract yet practical means to develop scalable solutions to real-world problems.

As one of the top rankers in my college, most of whose professors were PhD scholars from Jadavpur University and other such institutions, many projects were up for grabs for me. I picked those that seemed to relate to real-world problems and resonate with me. The research on cell segmentation within healthcare was not some abstract exercise. It would determine algorithms of artificial intelligence to count disease cells, which had important applications in medicine. A rising count of diseased cells is bad; constant or decreasing counts indicate positive developments, such as the success of a treatment. This project was not just theoretical, but for the improvement of real-world healthcare. This experience has taught me that, if the right resources are in place, technology can lead to relevantly impactful innovations of lifesaving proportions.

In my free time, I would go from time to time whatever my busy schedule allowed me to teach poor students at my house. My mother provides free tuition for the poor, so that is what inspired me to do likewise. It was watching her spend her time and resources helping other people that inspired me to do the same. It wasn't only just a teaching thing for me that was just to pass on knowledge but to give these people tools so that they believe in themselves and their capabilities.

This has also made me believe that education can work very effectively in helping break cycles of poverty and bring about real changes in society.

I also had the chance to manage initiatives for my mom's philanthropic efforts. She collects funds and reaches areas larger foundations cannot because of bureaucratic permit requirements or other reasons. Working within these grassroots initiatives has demanded an ongoing assessment of how funds are spent, identifying immediate needs, and maximizing our impact in real time. For example, I've helped prioritize spending on nutritious food packages and vocational workshops, ensuring that our contributions provide families with lasting sustenance rather than fleeting relief.

This experience has taught me that leadership is about listening, understanding community needs, and making decisions that truly benefit people. An essential takeaway here is that money functions not just as a resource, but as a tool to enhance scale and speed, for turning small efforts into meaningful, large-scale solutions that reach the people who need them most.

My journey has now led me to UC Berkeley, an institution known for its commitment to inclusive innovation and leadership in AI. Here, I'm excited to learn, collaborate, and grow alongside peers who share my vision of using technology and finance to tackle society's biggest challenges. Berkeley is the ideal environment to turn ideas into solutions that make a tangible difference in people's lives. Success for me does not mean achieving admiring applause but creating ripples that traverse the ages.

I would be more than delighted to research at Berkeley as a graduate student, cooperating with peer learners who think like me on the systemic issues. I feel that with proper convergence of technology and financial strategy and human empathy, we can come up with solutions that cross borders and lift up and empower communities around the world. At Berkeley, where bold ideas become groundbreaking realities, I'm ready to contribute to a future where innovation breaks down barriers and serves not the privileged few but the broader world. I'm excited about the challenges awaiting me and look forward to becoming an integral part of this dynamic community.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,
Aniket Ghosh